

DOCUMENT 02

User Personas

Four primary personas — Tier 1 Buyer, Tier 2 Buyer, Seller, and Compliance Officer — anchored in real Ghanaian gold-sector archetypes.

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SPONSOR Ghana Chamber of Gold Buyers

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Document 2 — User Personas

Four primary personas anchor the design of the AurumX platform. Each is fictional but anchored in real stakeholder archetypes observed in the Ghanaian gold-buying sector. Names, ages, frustrations, and quotes are deliberately specific so that engineering, design, and product decisions can be tested against concrete user models rather than abstract types. Where a persona implies a feature priority, that implication is listed explicitly so it can be traced to the backlog.

2.1 Persona 1 — Kwame Asare, Tier 1 Buyer

ATTRIBUTE	DETAIL
Name	Kwame Asare
Age	52
Job title	Head of West African Sourcing, Helvetia Refining AG (LBMA Good Delivery refiner)
Technical skill level	High. Daily user of Bloomberg Terminal, SAP S/4HANA, internal trade tools; skeptical of consumer-grade UX.
Industry	Precious metals refining & bullion trading
Company size	~2,400 employees globally; West African sourcing team of 8
Annual procurement budget	US\$250M–\$400M of doré and refined gold

GOALS

- Source 30–50 kg of gold per week from Ghanaian Tier 2 sellers and aggregators at or below the LBMA benchmark, with full provenance documentation for Swiss import compliance.
- Pre-qualify and maintain a vetted panel of 12–15 Ghanaian counterparties whose KYC, licensing, and AML status are continuously validated.
- Reduce per-deal administrative overhead from 6–8 hours to under 1 hour.
- Receive early visibility of large lots (≥ 5 kg, $\geq 99.5\%$ purity) with right of first refusal where possible.
- Maintain an audit trail defensible against Swiss FINMA and OECD Due Diligence Guidance reviews.

PAIN POINTS

Counterparty discovery is relationship-bound — most deals happen through WhatsApp and personal phone calls. Documentation is paper-heavy and error-prone. Provenance gaps create compliance risk under OECD

Annex II. Price opacity at the local level means Kwame's team cannot verify whether aggregator quotes are fair. No early-warning system exists for supply disruptions.

> I do not need another marketplace. I need a verified counterparty on the other side of every kilogram, with paper that survives a FINMA audit.

PRODUCT IMPLICATIONS

IMPLICATION	PRIORITY	PHASE
Verified counterparty directory with live license status	High	Phase 1
Tier 1 pre-notification with optional RFQ exclusivity window	High	Phase 2
Full provenance chain with hash-anchored documents	High	Phase 2–3
OECD Annex II red-flag indicators on counterparty profiles	High	Phase 1
API access for SAP integration (push purchase orders, pull confirmations)	Medium	Phase 2
Desktop-first UX; mobile is read-only for trade review	High	Phase 1
Price benchmarking widget showing LBMA fix + local premium	Medium	Phase 2

2.2 Persona 2 — Abena Owusu, Tier 2 Buyer

ATTRIBUTE	DETAIL
Name	Abena Owusu
Age	34
Job title	Managing Director, GoldLink Exports Ltd. (Accra-based licensed gold exporter)
Technical skill level	Medium-High. Power user of Excel, WhatsApp Business, Google Workspace; limited API literacy.
Industry	Gold export & aggregation

ATTRIBUTE	DETAIL
Company size	12 employees
Annual export volume	80–150 kg/year, primarily to UAE and India

GOALS

- Maintain a steady pipeline of 8–12 kg of gold per week for export, sourced from 4–6 trusted aggregators.
- Reduce the time from gold-in-vault to export permit approved from 10–14 days to under 5 days.
- Negotiate better margins by accessing multiple competing seller offers.
- Manage export documentation, customs filings, and PMMC paperwork in one place.
- Build a track record that lets her access trade finance from her bank.

PAIN POINTS

Liquidity is unpredictable — when an aggregator relationship falters, she has no fast way to find vetted alternatives. Documentation is exhausting — exporting one shipment requires 7 documents across 4 agencies with different portals. Price discovery is opaque. Bank credit is hard — despite a clean track record, her bank treats her as high-risk. Cash flow timing is brutal — she pays sellers within 48 hours but buyers pay on T+7 to T+30 terms, leaving her bearing all settlement risk.

> If I can move gold from vault to export permit in five days instead of fourteen, I can take three more shipments a month. That is the difference between surviving and growing.

PRODUCT IMPLICATIONS

IMPLICATION	PRIORITY	PHASE
Mobile-first UX for trade review and document management	Critical	Phase 1
One-stop export documentation workflow (PMMC, GRA, BoG)	High	Phase 3
RFQ comparison view showing multiple seller offers side-by-side	High	Phase 2
Escrow as the default settlement method, with bank integration	High	Phase 2
Trade history export (PDF + structured) for bank trade finance	High	Phase 2

IMPLICATION	PRIORITY	PHASE
Bidirectional SMS / WhatsApp notifications (not just email)	Medium	Phase 1
Lightweight financial dashboard showing cash flow and P&L	Medium	Phase 3

2.3 Persona 3 — Ibrahim Toure, Seller

ATTRIBUTE	DETAIL
Name	Ibrahim Toure
Age	48
Job title	General Secretary, Banda Small-Scale Miners Cooperative (Upper West Region)
Technical skill level	Low-Medium. Comfortable with basic smartphone apps; struggles with complex forms.
Industry	Artisanal and small-scale gold mining (ASM) and aggregation
Organization size	Cooperative of ~140 small-scale miners; ~3 kg/week throughput
License type	Minerals Commission Small-Scale Mining License + Inter-Regional Gold Buyer Permit

GOALS

- Sell the cooperative's gold at the best available price without traveling to Accra for every negotiation.
- Receive payment within 48 hours of delivery — currently the cooperative waits 5–10 days.
- Build a verifiable, auditable record of production and sales to qualify for fair-trade certifications.
- Reduce dependence on a single aggregator-middleman who currently takes a 4–6% margin.
- Get proactive alerts when buyer demand spikes.

PAIN POINTS

Logistics are dangerous and expensive — transporting 2–3 kg of gold by road from Wa to Accra costs US\$800–1,200. Buyer default risk is real — the cooperative has been burned twice. Price discovery is broken — they get one middleman's quote with no way to know if it is fair. Documentation is hard to

maintain — the last license renewal took 11 weeks. No access to finance — no bank will advance working capital against future sales.

> We mine the gold. Someone else sets the price. If this platform lets me see three offers before I sell, and the money is in escrow before the gold leaves my hand, I will use it every week.

PRODUCT IMPLICATIONS

IMPLICATION	PRIORITY	PHASE
Extremely low-bandwidth mobile UX; SMS fallback	Critical	Phase 1
One-tap lot creation with photo + weight capture from phone	High	Phase 2
Escrow visible to seller before gold leaves possession	Critical	Phase 2
WhatsApp-based trade confirmations and document delivery	High	Phase 1
Localized pricing display (USD primary, GHS secondary with FX source)	High	Phase 2
Voice-guided onboarding in English + Twi + Hausa	Medium	Phase 1
Group/cooperative account with multi-user roles	High	Phase 1
Demand-spike alerts via SMS when buyer RFQs target cooperative's region	Medium	Phase 2

2.4 Persona 4 — Efua Boateng, Compliance Officer

ATTRIBUTE	DETAIL
Name	Efua Boateng
Age	44
Job title	Director of Compliance & Member Affairs, Ghana Chamber of Gold Buyers

ATTRIBUTE	DETAIL
Technical skill level	High. Former Big 4 auditor; comfortable with BI tools and SQL.
Industry	Industry association / regulatory compliance
Team	Chamber staff of 18; Efua's team of 3 covers compliance, onboarding, dispute resolution
Education	MSc Forensic Accounting; CA (Ghana); AML certification (ICA)

GOALS

- Provide the Chamber's Executive Council with monthly compliance health metrics with drill-down to specific trades.
- Reduce average time to onboard a new member from 4–6 weeks to under 5 business days.
- Detect and investigate suspicious trading patterns within 24 hours of occurrence.
- Maintain an audit trail defensible against Bank of Ghana, Minerals Commission, and FATF review.
- Standardize and automate quarterly compliance reporting to regulators.

> I am not asking for magic. I am asking for one source of truth, with timestamps, that I can hand to a Bank of Ghana examiner at 9 AM on a Monday.

PRODUCT IMPLICATIONS

IMPLICATION	PRIORITY	PHASE
Real-time compliance dashboard with drill-down to trade level	High	P1→P4
Workflow engine for member onboarding with parallel cross-checks	High	Phase 1
Sanction list screening integrated with daily refresh	Critical	Phase 1
Anomaly detection with explainable alerts (rule-based + ML)	High	P2/P4
Immutable audit log with hash-anchored records	Critical	Phase 1
Dispute resolution module with shared trade fact view	Medium	Phase 3

IMPLICATION	PRIORITY	PHASE
Automated quarterly regulatory report generation	High	Phase 4